

Middle East Daily Brief

June 26, 2026

Executive summary

8 stories from 7 outlets (6 perspectives) over the reporting window. Leading the day: UN pauses Strait of Hormuz evacuation after cargo ship struck; US blames Iranian drone.

Top stories

1. **UN pauses Strait of Hormuz evacuation after cargo ship struck; US blames Iranian drone** *BBC, Al Jazeera, CBS News, CNN, Euronews, Washington Times · corroborated by 6 outlets* A cargo vessel was hit on its starboard side by an 'unknown projectile' about 7.5 nautical miles off the coast of Oman, damaging the bridge, with no casualties reported. The International Maritime Organization paused its plan to evacuate... <https://www.bbc.co.uk/news/articles/cjwg9np904qo>
2. **Iran declares new Hormuz route 'unacceptable and dangerous', warns ships against unauthorized passage** *Al Arabiya, Al Jazeera, Arab News, CBS News, Euronews · corroborated by 5 outlets* Iran on June 25 described the alternative Strait of Hormuz transit route as 'unacceptable and dangerous' and warned vessels against crossing without Tehran's clearance. The IRGC said safe passage would only be guaranteed along... <https://english.alarabiya.net/News/gulf>
3. **Oil prices spike as much as 4% then ease after Hormuz evacuation halt** *Al Jazeera, CNBC, Reuters · corroborated by 3 outlets* Brent crude rose as much as 4 percent after the IMO suspended its Hormuz evacuation plan following the attack on a cargo ship, before paring gains and falling more than 2 percent on Friday. Brent had climbed near \$74.70 a barrel as... <https://www.aljazeera.com/economy/2026/6/26/oil-prices-climb-after-attack-in-strait-of-hormuz-halts-evacuation-plan>
4. **Israeli strike near Nabatieh kills three in south Lebanon despite ceasefire** *Middle East Eye, Al Jazeera, Times of Israel · corroborated by 3 outlets* Lebanon's health ministry said an Israeli strike on a car in Mayfadoun, near Nabatieh, on June 25 killed three people and wounded one, according to a statement carried by Lebanon's National News Agency. The strike came amid a fragile... <https://www.middleeasteye.net/news>
5. **Gulf states back US-Iran deal as analysts say Israel's war backfired** *Al Jazeera, Arab News · corroborated by 2 outlets* All six Gulf Cooperation Council states welcomed the US-Iran memorandum of understanding, a stance analysts attributed to hard-headed pragmatism and a desire to end the war rather than newfound trust in Tehran. The GCC statement condemned... <https://www.aljazeera.com/features/2026/6/25/hard-headed-pragmatism-israels-war-backfires-as-gulf-backs-us-iran-mou>
6. **Gaza civil-military coordination hub to be overhauled and renamed International Gaza Aid Center** *Times of Israel, Reuters · corroborated by 2 outlets* The Civil-Military Coordination Center in Kiryat Gat is set to be overhauled to make it more operational and tie it more closely to US President Trump's Board of Peace, according to three diplomats, and will be renamed the International... <https://www.timesofisrael.com/liveblog-june-25-2026/>

By theme

Israel – Gaza & the Palestinians

- **Gaza civil-military coordination hub to be overhauled and renamed International Gaza Aid Center** — Times of Israel, Reuters <https://www.timesofisrael.com/liveblog-june-25-2026/>
- **Palestinian man killed in Israeli raid near Salfit in occupied West Bank** — Middle East Monitor, Middle East Eye <https://www.middleeastmonitor.com/category/region/middle-east/palestine/>

Iran & the US

- **UN pauses Strait of Hormuz evacuation after cargo ship struck; US blames Iranian drone** — BBC, Al Jazeera, CBS News, CNN, Euronews, Washington Times <https://www.bbc.co.uk/news/articles/cjwg9r>
- **Iran declares new Hormuz route 'unacceptable and dangerous', warns ships against unauthorized passage** — Al Arabiya, Al Jazeera, Arab News, CBS News, Euronews <https://english.alarabiya.net/News/gulf>
- **Oil prices spike as much as 4% then ease after Hormuz evacuation halt** — Al Jazeera, CNBC, Reuters <https://www.aljazeera.com/economy/2026/6/26/oil-prices-climb-after-attack-in-strait-of-hormuz-halts-evacuation-plan>
- **Gulf states back US-Iran deal as analysts say Israel's war backfired** — Al Jazeera, Arab News <https://www.aljazeera.com/features/2026/6/25/hard-headed-pragmatism-israels-war-backfires-as-gulf-backs-us-iran-mou>
- **US-Iran deconfliction channel to base IRGC and CENTCOM officers in Qatar, Vance says** — CBS News, Al Jazeera <https://www.cbsnews.com/live-updates/us-iran-war-trump-strait-of-hormuz-oil-prices/>

Israel – politics & society

- **Israeli strike near Nabatieh kills three in south Lebanon despite ceasefire** — Middle East Eye, Al Jazeera, Times of Israel <https://www.middleeasteye.net/news>

Perspective balance

Perspective	Stories
international	2
Qatari	2
Saudi	1
Israeli	1
independent	1
pro-Palestinian	1

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